

Mastercard Inc.

2Q26 Earnings Recap

Strong beat led by VAS and cross-border.

Mastercard delivered strong 2Q results, with a top- and bottom-line beat, and organic FXN revenue growth coming in at ~12%, above management's guidance for the low-end of low-double digits, while adj. EPS of \$5.04 was ~6% above Street consensus. While management maintained FY26 guidance for high-end of low-double digits adj. organic FXN revenue growth, there was a small, implicit organic FXN raise when considering the GAAP revenue growth raise. Management increased the GAAP revenue growth outlook (to LT from HE of LDD to LT) despite the reduction of the expected currency tailwind (to 1% from 1.5%). Management affirmed this on the call, stating "we now expect [growth] to be higher within the range than our prior expectations." In our view, the positive stock reaction to the quarter was largely driven by two factors: VAS sequential acceleration on a 2-year basis and stronger cross-border volume/revenue than feared.

To the first point, VAS 2-year organic FXN growth accelerated ~4pts sequentially, with management highlighting strong demand for Mastercard's differentiated solutions (particularly in Safety and Security, which has been strengthened by the acquisition of Recorded Future and is benefiting from market tailwinds in cyber/security, data and AI, etc.). VAS revenue growth was also supported by strong tokenization trends (tokenization share of switched transactions increased ~5pts YoY, for the second consecutive year, to >40%), which have meaningful long-term runway, especially as Mastercard's share of processed transactions is also increasing. Mastercard's cross-border volume and revenue (+6% vs. Street) also came in better than expected following weak April MTD trends of 6% FXN growth (ex. intra-Europe, disclosed on the last call), with an intra-quarter acceleration bringing 2Q to 11% growth. The reacceleration through the remainder of 2Q (7%/12%/15% in April/May/June) was driven by better-than-expected trends in the Middle East (improved consumer outbound, higher flight capacity), holiday normalization, a (hard to quantify) benefit from the World Cup, improved (high-value) Venezuela outbound due to re-dollarization, and the pull-forward of a "large retail promotion event" (Prime Day). Overall, we believe investors will come away from the quarter with increased confidence in Mastercard's ability to continue to compound revenues in the LDD-LT range over the long-term as the company executes on its VAS strategy amidst a dynamic macro environment, further bolstered by Mastercard's globally diversified business.

What We Liked: 1) Value-added services growth held flat sequentially at ~18% organic FXN, representing a 4pt acceleration on a 2-year basis, increasing our confidence that Mastercard's VAS revenue growth can sustain its high-teens trajectory. The company pointed to strong demand for a) security solutions, b) consumer acquisition and engagement, c) digital and authentication, and d) business and market insights, as well as pricing, as drivers of growth. Further, VAS revenue growth is supported by increased tokenization penetration of switched transactions (up ~5pts YoY, 2 years consecutively), as well as overall switched transaction

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MA	OVERWEIGHT Unchanged
U.S. Payments & Fintech	POSITIVE Unchanged
Price Target	USD 660.00 raised 3% from USD 640.00
Price (30-Jul-26)	USD 577.35
Potential Upside/Downside	+14.3%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

Market Cap (USD mn)	505875
Shares Outstanding (mn)	876.20
Free Float (%)	91.79
52 Wk Avg Daily Volume (mn)	3.3
Dividend Yield (%)	0.60
Return on Equity TTM (%)	241.49
Current BVPS (USD)	6.39
Source: Bloomberg	

Price Performance	Exchange-NYSE
52 Week range	USD 601.77-464.52



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg
[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

U.S. Payments & Fintech

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penetration; **2)** Switched transaction penetration expanded to 72% in 2Q26, up 5pts YoY and improved from 65%/55% in FY23/FY18, respectively. Management attributes this share growth to Mastercard's strong value proposition (especially compared to local networks). Further, the company is expanding its role in switching by flexing its network architecture; **3)** Cross-Border Assessments increased 20% FXN in 2Q26, an 8pt spread (up from 5pts in 1Q26) to FXN cross-border volume growth of 12%. The difference was driven primarily by pricing in international markets and mix (e.g., US inbound, Venezuela outbound), with other factors supporting volumes discussed in a paragraph below; **4)** US switched volume increased 6% YoY, but grew 10% ex. the Capital One debit portfolio (the migration of which was "basically complete" in 1Q). In addition to broad-based consumer and business spending strength, management highlighted a tailwind from higher fuel prices, as well as (a hard-to-quantify) benefit from the World Cup; **5)** Commercial credit and debit volumes grew 12%, representing slight acceleration from the 11%/11% growth the company reported for FY25/FY24.

What We Are Watching: **1)** Mastercard noted a lower-than-anticipated impact from the geopolitical conflict in the Middle East, a key driver of the quarterly outperformance vs. guidance. Looking ahead, management now expects the impact from the Middle East conflict to remain at a similar level to that seen "towards the end of 2Q." Management grew increasingly confident through the back-half of the quarter as a result of strong outbound spend trends, supported by, in part, increasing capacity from flights and airlines; **2)** Mastercard expects the previously announced BVNK acquisition to close in 3Q. While no material inorganic revenue impact is embedded in guidance, the company's expectation for 2026 Non-GAAP Opex growth attributable to inorganic activity (BVNK acquisition, SessionM divestiture) moved by 50-100bps.

Cross-Border Volume: Mastercard's cross-border volumes came in better than expected at 11% YoY FXN (ex. intra-Europe) relative to 6% in the April trends disclosed on the last earnings call. The intra-quarter improvement was largely driven by an improvement in travel accelerating to 8/7% in May/June (from 2% in April). As previously disclosed, XB travel volumes decelerated to 2% in April (from 8% in 1Q) due to three items: holiday timing shifts in April, the conflict in the Middle East, and the loss of an OTA. The improvement observed in May, June, and July MTD (8/7/8%) was supported by better outbound trends in GCC countries alongside increasing airline flight capacity (better than expected), and likely benefits from the World Cup (hard to quantify). In addition, cross-border card-not-present ex. travel accelerated from 19/18% in April/May to 23% in June due to "timing of large retail promotional events" (e.g., Prime Day), with management also calling out benefits from Venezuela. More specifically, management said that increased availability of US dollars in Venezuela has led consumers to more aggressively utilize those dollars for cross-border spending, which primarily occurs in the form of cross-border CNP.

Additional Points: **1)** Token penetration reached over 40% of switched transactions in 2Q26, up from ~35% in 1Q25 and ~30% in FY24; **2)** Mastercard divested SessionM on May 1st, which had a de minimis impact on VAS revenue. Though the revenue impact is expected to be largely offset by the incremental revenue from BVNK (anticipated to close in 3Q26), management expects the transactions to add net ~50-100bps to adj. operating expense growth; **3)** Venezuela was a contributor to cross-border strength during the quarter, due to the increased availability of US dollars for consumers. Specifically, while Venezuela was deconsolidated from volumes and revenues in 2018 due to difficulty in repatriating funds, cross-border transactions from the country that are in US dollars still contribute to metrics. Therefore, the easier access to US dollars for Venezuelan consumers during the quarter was a benefit to card-not-present ex-travel volume, with stablecoin purchases a particular tailwind, per Mastercard; **4)** Management affirmed an implicit revenue guidance raise on the call, stating "we now expect [growth] to be higher within the range than our prior expectations."

Valuation: We increase our price target to \$660 (from \$640) as we apply a 29x P/E multiple (vs. 28x prior) to our CY27E adj. EPS estimate of \$22.88 (vs. \$22.78 prior). Our FY26E and FY27E adj. EPS estimates move slightly higher to reflect the 2Q outperformance. Risks for Mastercard include 1) a slowdown in international growth due to geopolitical or macro factors, which would have an outsized impact on Mastercard relative to competitor networks; 2) disintermediation of the networks caused by new technology such as crypto/stablecoins and agent commerce; and 3) a change in the regulatory environment that could impact Mastercard's pricing power.

MA: Quarterly and Annual EPS (USD)

	2025	2026			2027			Change y/y	
FY Dec	Actual	Old	New	Cons	Old	New	Cons	2026	2027
Q1	3.59A	4.35A	4.35A	4.60A	4.98E	4.88E	5.13E	21%	12%
Q2	4.07A	4.75E	4.97A	4.77E	5.64E	5.77E	5.59E	22%	16%
Q3	4.34A	5.07E	5.12E	5.11E	5.93E	6.11E	5.95E	18%	19%
Q4	4.52A	5.23E	5.10E	5.21E	6.24E	6.12E	6.13E	13%	20%
Year	16.52A	19.40E	19.54E	19.65E	22.78E	22.88E	22.78E	18%	17%
P/E	34.9		29.6			25.2			

Consensus numbers are from Bloomberg received on 30-Jul-2026; 12:50 GMT
Source: Barclays Research

U.S. Payments & FinTech

POSITIVE

MasterCard Inc. (MA)

OVERWEIGHT

Income statement (\$mn)	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E	CAGR
Revenue	32,791	37,220	42,020	47,263	13.0%
Incentives	-20,522	-24,555	-27,610	-30,631	N/A
Gross revenue	53,313	61,775	69,630	77,894	13.5%
EBIT	18,897	21,978	25,142	28,576	14.8%
Pre-tax income	18,578	21,532	24,642	28,076	14.8%
Net income	14,968	17,201	19,591	22,320	14.2%
EPS (reported) (\$)	16.52	19.54	22.88	26.73	17.4%
Diluted shares (mn)	907	881	857	835	-2.7%
DPS (\$)	3.04	3.48	3.54	3.65	6.3%
Margin and return data	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E	Average
EBIT margin (%)	57.6	59.0	59.8	60.5	59.2
Pre-tax margin (%)	56.7	57.9	58.6	59.4	58.1
Net margin (%)	45.6	46.2	46.6	47.2	46.4
Balance sheet (\$mn)	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E	CAGR
Tangible fixed assets	2,303	2,243	1,602	880	-27.4%
Intangible fixed assets	15,114	15,404	16,420	17,562	5.1%
Cash and equivalents	10,566	11,373	14,000	19,372	22.4%
Total assets	54,157	58,110	64,159	73,215	10.6%
Short and long-term debt	19,000	24,643	24,643	24,643	9.1%
Other long-term liabilities	5,091	5,583	6,303	7,089	11.7%
Total liabilities	46,411	51,652	54,207	56,962	7.1%
Net debt/(funds)	8,434	13,270	10,643	5,271	-14.5%
Shareholders' equity	7,737	6,462	9,956	16,258	28.1%
Valuation & leverage metrics	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E	Average
P/E (reported) (x)	34.9	29.6	25.2	21.6	27.8
EV/EBITDA (x)	25.9	22.5	19.6	17.1	21.3
Dividend yield (%)	0.5	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Selected operating metrics	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E	
Total volumes (\$bn)	10,645	11,627	12,561	13,551	
Total volume growth (%)	8.8	9.2	8.0	7.9	
Purchase volumes (\$bn)	8,810	9,731	10,604	11,532	
Purchase volume growth (%)	10.0	10.5	9.0	8.7	
Transactions processed (mn)	175,464	191,242	210,366	231,402	
Transactions processed growth (%)	10.1	9.0	10.0	10.0	
Purchase volume (% US)	33.6	32.3	31.7	30.9	
Purchase volume (% International)	66.4	67.7	68.3	69.1	
Net revenue/purchase vol (\$)	30.8	32.0	33.5	34.9	
Incentives % of gross revenue	51.3	53.5	54.0	54.1	

Price (30-Jul-2026) **USD 577.35**
Price Target **USD 660.00**

Why OVERWEIGHT?

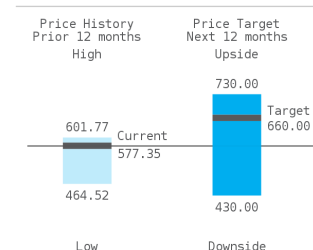
We think the card networks are well-positioned within our broader payments and Fintech coverage due to their unique role as industry standards setters with unmatched global scale, enabling Mastercard to increase volume while sustaining pricing power. We think this should translate to high-single to low-double-digit top-line growth and faster EPS growth.

Upside case USD 730.00

Our Upside Case of \$730 is based on 31x our 2027E Upside Case Adj. EPS estimate of \$23.52 which reflects higher revenue growth from faster growth in new flows and VAS, and corresponding operating leverage driving a higher net income margin.

Downside case USD 430.00

Our Downside Case of \$430 is based on 20x our 2027E Downside Case Adj. EPS estimate of \$21.72 which reflects lower revenue growth due to slower growth in new flows and less VAS adoption, and corresponding negative operating leverage driving a lower net income margin.

Upside/Downside scenarios

Note: FY End Dec

Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Primary Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)

Mastercard Inc. (MA, 30-Jul-2026, USD 577.35), Overweight/Positive, A/CD/CE/D/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. Payments & Fintech

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Toast Inc. (TOST)	Visa Inc. (V)	Western Union (WU)

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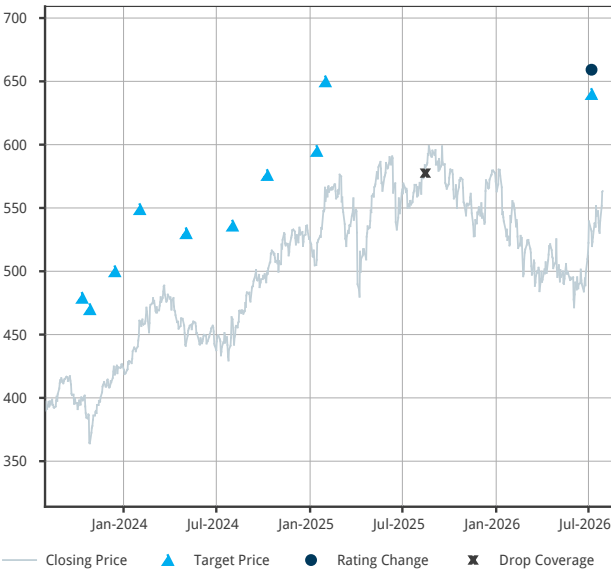
Mastercard Inc. (MA / MA)

Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 577.35** (30-Jul-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart (as of 30-Jul-2026)



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target	Currency
07-Jul-2026	539.39	Overweight	640.00	USD
08-Aug-2025	561.22	Coverage Dropped		USD
31-Jan-2025	555.43		650.00	USD
14-Jan-2025	509.02		595.00	USD
09-Oct-2024	497.06		576.00	USD
02-Aug-2024	462.41		536.00	USD
03-May-2024	443.58		530.00	USD
02-Feb-2024	460.58		549.00	USD
15-Dec-2023	418.57		500.00	USD
27-Oct-2023	364.08		470.00	USD
12-Oct-2023	399.90		479.00	USD

On 30-Jul-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 480.00 USD.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our \$660 Target Price is based on 29x our 2027E Adj. EPS estimate of \$22.88.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: Risks for Mastercard include the following: 1) Disintermediation of the networks caused by new technology such as crypto/stablecoins and agentic commerce; 2) a slowdown in international growth due to geopolitical or macro factors, which would have an outsized impact on Mastercard relative to competitor networks; and 3) A change in the regulatory environment that could impact Mastercard's pricing power.

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